



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's look at an Amish community!



Learning Outcome

Describe detailed facts about events or actions in work and social contexts, in written or spoken situations.

Ask your partner:

- What do you know about the Amish people?
- What other small religious groups are there in your country?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about history and civilization.
- I can talk about two connected actions.
- I can talk about an unusual or unique event in life.





Let's Explore!

The Amish are a **nonviolent*** religious group.

* The Amish believe in no violence at all. They will not even hit back if they are struck.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

The Amish are part a larger religious group of Anabaptist. Their name comes from a Swiss Mennonite bishop named Jakob Amman. It was Amman, who was believed to have started the practice of the community ignoring people after disobeying the rules of the church. Shunned people are expected to eat at separate tables at dinner time when dining with others from the community.

Although they have been known to receive money or help from family members, they themselves are not allowed to give or do anything for the faithful. This was thought to have been the best way to remind the wayward of their sin while seeking to bring them back into fellowship.

In the 18th century, the Amish came to the US after being persecuted in Europe. Many were thought to have traveled to Pennsylvania to enjoy religious freedom. They have been believed to have managed to keep their own special way of life by staying separate from the rest of American society.

The strictest Amish group has been known to have been the Old Order of Amish. They have continued to dress very plainly, using hooks instead of buttons on their clothes, while reflecting the dress of those who came before them. Although cars have been known to have been shunned by the Amish, they can accept a ride.

The Amish have been renowned to have chosen not to serve in the army, vote, or send their children to high school. Although times have changed, when being given the choice to stay or leave their communities, more than 85 percent decide to continue along their traditional path. Their faith and taking care of each other holds them together.





Let's Practice!

Edward has a school project about Amish religion! This is what he found.

Instructions: Read the text on page 2 again. Circle the correct answers for each question.

1. What happens when a person is shunned?
 - a.They are expected to eat at different tables.
 - b.They are able to receive help from family members.
 - c.They are allowed to give things to people.
 - d.They are reminded of the sin they committed.
 - e.They are expelled permanently from the community.
2. What are some of the things that have made the Amish unique?
 - a.They send their children away to high school.
 - b.They have chosen not to fight in wars.
 - c.They have given up their traditions.
 - d.They have decided not to vote.
 - e. They have given up on faith.



Let's Practice!

These are the keywords Edward found in Amish history.

Instructions: Organize the mystery words. Find the words in the word search below.

Words

1. MCTOISNUEMI _____
2. CTILIINVZOAI _____
3. IUELRIOSG _____
4. IATNCNE _____
5. EEOMRFD _____
6. OT USHN _____
7. AWDAYWR _____





Extension Activity

Watch the movie *Witness* with Harrison Ford.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Watch the film *Witness*.
- Take notes of anything that you find interesting about the Amish way of life.
- Discuss your opinion of Amish life with a partner or group using the film as a base for your discussion.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I watch the film *Witness*.

☐ ☐

I note things that I find interesting about the Amish way of life.

☐ ☐

I share my opinions with a partner or group.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **religious** (adjective): faithful to or believing in a religion
e.g. The Amish are part of a larger religious group of Anabaptist.
- **practice** (noun): the repetition of an activity or skill
e.g. Amman was believed to have started the practice of the community ignoring people after disobeying the rules of the church.
- **wayward** (noun): people who have lost their way spiritually or morally
e.g. This was thought to have been the best way to remind the wayward of their sin while seeking to bring them back into fellowship.
- **sin** (noun): a transgression or action that is against moral values or religion
e.g. Killing is a sin.
- **to seek** (verb): to look for
e.g. The Amish always seek a way to bring those that have strayed back into the church.
- **plainly** (adverb): without adornment or decoration
e.g. They have continued to dress very plainly, using hooks instead of buttons on their clothes, while reflecting the dress of those who came before them.
- **to shun** (verb): to avoid
e.g. Shunned people are expected to eat at separate tables at dinner time when dining with the others from the community.





Learning Points

Adverbial Clauses of Time, Reduced Forms

You use adverbial clauses of time to show when something happens. Using adverbial clauses makes your speech and writing sound more dynamic and sophisticated.

Adverbial clauses of time are usually introduced by the time adverbs: *before, after, as, when, while, until, as soon as, since, no sooner than, as long as.*

For example:

*I like to read a book **before I go to sleep.***

*Will you wait here **until I'm ready?***

*I wasn't there **when you came to see me.***

***As soon as she got home,** she started making dinner.*

Adverbial clauses of time can be placed before or after the main clause of the sentence. It is separated with a comma when it comes before the main clause, but the comma is not used when the adverb clause comes after the main clause.

To make your writing more concise, you can use a reduced form of an adverbial phrase. To do this, you need to make sure that the subject of both clauses is the same.

For example: *I always take a shower **before going to bed.***

Examples:

- *They were shunned after disobeying the rules of the church.*
- *It reminded the wayward of their sin while seeking to bring them back into fellowship.*
- *In the 18th century, the Amish came to the US after being persecuted in Europe.*
- *They have continued to dress very plainly, while reflecting the dress of those who came before them.*
- *Shunned people are expected to eat at separate tables at dinnertime when dining with the others from the community.*
- *Although times have changed, when being given the choice to stay or leave their communities, more than 85 percent decide to continue along their traditional path.*





Learning Points

Reporting Past Events in the Passive Voice

In reports, stories and articles which refer to past events, it is common to use the passive voice.

You use a passive structure when you want the 'receiver' of the action to be the subject, rather than the 'doer' or agent.

You use the **Simple Past Passive** to report about finished actions or events that happened at a specified time in the past.

For example: *It was Amman, who was believed to have started the practice of the community ignoring people.*

The structure of the **Simple Past Passive** is:

subject + *was/were* + past participle

You use the **Present Perfect Passive** to report about a finished action or event with present consequences. There is a connection between what happened in the past and the present. There is no specified time.

For example: *Although they have been known to receive money or help from family members, they themselves are not allowed to give or do anything for the faithful.*

The structure of the **Present Perfect Passive** is:

subject + *has/have been* + past participle

Examples:

- *This was thought to have been the best way to remind the wayward of their sin.*
- *Many were thought to have traveled to Pennsylvania to enjoy religious freedom.*
- *They have been believed to have managed to keep their own special way of life by staying separate from the rest of American society.*
- *The strictest Amish group has been known to have been the Old Order of Amish.*
- *Although cars have been known to have been shunned by the Amish, they can accept a ride.*
- *The Amish have been renowned to have chosen not serve in the army, vote, or send their children to high school.*

